

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Wednesday, 13 May 2026

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow.

01 — NEWS

3 stories · max 1 political

Today's top stories

1 The King opens Parliament today, with the King's Speech setting out the government's legislative programme against a turbulent political backdrop.

State Opening goes ahead this morning following last week's local elections, in which Reform UK gained close to 1,450 council seats and took control of more than a dozen councils, while Labour shed nearly 1,500 councillors. Sir Keir Starmer is facing renewed pressure from inside his own party — but the ceremony itself will be the day's defining image, with all the usual pomp, procession and televised arrival at Westminster.

POLITICS · WESTMINSTER

2 A bitter blast of cold has set a new record low for the UK in May, with the mercury falling to -6.1°C overnight in the Scottish Highlands.

Altnaharra in Sutherland recorded the coldest May night ever logged in the UK, while Shetland was hit by heavy snow showers. Forecasters say a brief warm-up is on the way later in the week, but the cold snap has already prompted late frost warnings for growers and gardeners across northern England and Scotland, with allotment forums in full panic mode about potato crops.

WEATHER · UK-WIDE

3 A-level and GCSE exam season gets fully under way this week, with millions of students sitting their first written papers across England, Wales and Northern Ireland.

Schools are reporting record numbers of pupils accessing wellbeing support during exam fortnight, and the major exam boards have re-issued guidance on phone-free exam halls after a string of "smart-glasses" incidents during mock exams earlier this term. Universities, meanwhile, say they're preparing for what could be a tighter clearing window than usual once results land in August.

EDUCATION · UK-WIDE

What's coming up

1 **Eurovision week is finally upon us, with the UK's Sam Battle — performing as Look Mum No Computer — set to take to the stage tomorrow night.**

The synth-tinkering YouTuber-turned-pop-star will perform the UK entry "Eins, Zwei, Drei" as a guest spot during Thursday's second semi-final, before the Grand Final on Saturday 16 May. The UK is automatically through to the final as a Big Four nation. Bookmakers currently have Sweden and Italy as joint favourites, with the UK floating somewhere in the mid-table — but Look Mum No Computer's homemade synth rig is being talked about as a potential dark-horse moment.

EUROVISION • THIS WEEK

2 **The 79th Cannes Film Festival is in full swing on the Croisette, with the Palme d'Or race officially under way and a host of huge premieres lined up over the next ten days.**

South Korean director Park Chan-wook is heading this year's jury, with Pierre Salvadori's "The Electric Kiss" opening proceedings. Among the most-anticipated films screening this week and next: John Travolta's directorial debut, a new Lynne Ramsay drama, and a remastered Pan's Labyrinth screening to mark the film's anniversary. Cannes runs through to Saturday 23 May, with the closing film "Adieu Monde Cruel" by Félix de Givry.

FILM • CANNES 12-23 MAY

3 **"Mortal Kombat II" punches into UK cinemas this Friday — with the IMAX release backed by what Warner Bros is calling its biggest marketing push of the year.**

The sequel to the 2021 reboot has been four years in the making and is expected to open big against modest competition. Cast members are still doing the rounds on UK chat shows this week ahead of release. One to flag for any film-and-gaming-leaning shows on Friday.

FILM • FRI 15 MAY

On the schedule

1 **All ten Premier League games kick off at the same time at 3pm BST on Sunday 24 May for the final day of the 2025/26 season.**

Wolves and Burnley are already down — Wolves confirmed on 20 April and Burnley a fortnight later — but the third relegation spot is still being scrapped over. At the other end, Champions League places aren't all settled either, after Manchester United's late 3-2 win over Liverpool at Old Trafford last weekend nudged them back into the top five.

FOOTBALL · SUN 24 MAY

2 **The Championship play-off final is at Wembley on Saturday 23 May, with Middlesbrough vs Southampton in the second semi tonight after Hull's win in their first leg.**

Hull City beat Millwall 2-0 in the second leg at The Den on Monday night to book their place in the final. Middlesbrough and Southampton meet at St Mary's tonight after a goalless draw at the Riverside last week — the winner will face Hull at Wembley for a place in next season's Premier League.

FOOTBALL · TONIGHT + SAT 23 MAY

3 **The ICC Women's T20 World Cup gets under way in just over a month, with England and Wales hosting from 12 June to 5 July.**

It's the first time the tournament has been hosted in the UK since 2009 and ticket sales are reportedly outpacing every previous edition. England's squad announcement is expected later this month, with selectors said to be considering a couple of bolters off the back of strong county form.

CRICKET · 12 JUN – 5 JUL

4 **Sunderland have become the first newly promoted club to confirm survival in their first Premier League season since 2022/23.**

After their draw with Wolves at the weekend, the Stadium of Light hasn't seen a top-flight survival party in nearly a decade. The club will now turn its attention to summer planning — and to keeping hold of the two or three players who've reportedly attracted bigger-club interest.

FOOTBALL · SUNDERLAND

Quick hits

- 1 Brits now spend an average of 14 hours a week on streaming — more than cooking, cleaning and exercising combined.**

The biggest jump is in the over-55s, who used to be the holdouts for live telly. "Second-screening" — phone in one hand, remote in the other — means we're paying less attention to what's on than ever.
- 2 62% of us have lied about reading a book to look smart in front of someone we fancy.**

The most-faked titles: 1984, Pride and Prejudice and (somewhat awkwardly) the Bible. One in five admit to nodding along to an entire dinner-party conversation about a novel they'd only seen the cover of.
- 3 Holiday firms report a 40% spike in "shoulder season" bookings — September and October sun trips are way up on last year.**

Travellers blame the cost of school-holiday flights, unreliable summer weather, and "August feels too crowded these days". Spain, Greece and Portugal top the wish list.
- 4 More than half of UK workers would take a 10% pay cut to never go into the office again — but only 17% of bosses say they'd offer one.**

The gap is growing again after forced return-to-office rules. HR experts say the tension is showing up in resignation rates, particularly among under-35s.
- 5 Three quarters of dog owners now talk to their dog more than they talk to their partner.**

Top topics include "what we're doing later", "what we just saw out the window" and a surprising amount of Bake Off commentary. 12% admit they've apologised to the dog after a row with the human in the house.
- 6 Britain's most-stolen supermarket item in 2026 isn't meat or cheese — it's olive oil, with theft up 220% year on year.**

Prices have nearly doubled in two years thanks to bad harvests in Spain and Italy. Some shops have fitted security tags to single bottles; others have moved premium brands behind the counter — like cigarettes.
- 7 The fastest-growing hobby of 2026 is, somewhat unexpectedly, hand-embroidery — sales of needles and thread up 180% in a year.**

Crafters say it's the perfect "phone detox" — slow, tactile, satisfying. TikTok is full of 20-somethings showing off custom denim jackets. Knitting has plateaued, which knitting forums are absolutely fuming about.
- 8 Almost two thirds of us say we've cried at a podcast in the last year — grief, parenting and identity top the list of triggers.**

Researchers reckon it's the intimacy of audio that does it. The figure is even higher for under-30s, 71% of whom admit a recent podcast-induced tear.

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

- Q** 71% of us admit to doing **THIS** in the car when we think no-one is watching. What is it?
ANSWER: SINGING AT THE TOP OF OUR LUNGS, WITH FULL DRAMATIC FACIAL EXPRESSIONS.
- Q** Asked "what's the most British thing about your morning?", the number one answer wasn't a cup of tea — it was **THIS**.
ANSWER: APOLOGISING TO SOMEONE WHO WALKED INTO YOU.

TALK TOPIC

- **A new study says we form a strong opinion of someone within 7 seconds of meeting them.**
 Talk-back question: what's the quickest you've ever decided you didn't like someone — and were you right?
 Bonus: the quickest you've ever decided you DID like someone?
- **Matching pet-and-owner outfits are apparently making a comeback this summer.**
 Would you actually do it? And if so — does the dog get a vote in the wardrobe?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

- FACT** **UK News.** A council in the North-West has agreed to fix a much-complained-about pothole only after a resident planted a small tree in it and the photo went viral. The pothole had been reported 17 times in a year before the tree solved it overnight.
- FICTION** **Made up, but believable.** A Devon village has voted unanimously to ban Vinted couriers from parking on its narrow high street, after a single delivery driver reportedly knocked over the same pub's hanging basket three weeks in a row.

06 — LOTTERY

estimated · this week

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£75 million

Friday 15 May 2026 · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Saturday 16 May 2026 · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

8 to choose from

Did you know?

- A cloud can weigh more than a million pounds — about the same as 100 elephants. They float because they're spread out across miles of sky.
- Honey never spoils. Edible honey has been found in 3,000-year-old Egyptian tombs and is still perfectly fine to eat.
- Octopuses have three hearts and blue blood. Two pump blood through the gills, the third pumps it round the body.
- The Eiffel Tower can grow up to 15cm taller in summer because the iron expands in the heat.
- The dot above a lowercase "i" or "j" has a name — it's called a tittle.
- Bananas are technically berries. Strawberries, somehow, are not.
- Wombats produce cube-shaped poo, and scientists only recently worked out why — it's down to the elasticity of their intestines.
- A "jiffy" is an actual unit of time — 1/100th of a second. So "back in a jiffy" is, technically, the fastest promise you can make.

On this day

Day 133 of the year, 232 days left in 2026. Today is Top Gun Day, International Hummus Day, World Cocktail Day, National Apple Pie Day, Leprechaun Day, and World Facilities Management Day. Star sign Taurus, birthstone Emerald.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1939 — Harvey Keitel (87), American actor (Reservoir Dogs, Taxi Driver, From Dusk Till Dawn).
- 1949 — Zoë Wanamaker (77), American-born British actress (My Family, Harry Potter and the Philosopher's Stone).
- 1950 — Stevie Wonder (76), American singer-songwriter ("Isn't She Lovely", "Superstition").
- 1951 — Selina Scott (75), English television presenter (Breakfast Time, The Clothes Show).
- 1956 — Richard Madeley (70), English television presenter (This Morning, Richard & Judy).
- 1961 — Dennis Rodman (65), American former NBA player (Chicago Bulls).
- 1964 — Stephen Colbert (62), American satirist and host of The Late Show.
- 1964 — Lorraine McIntosh (62), Scottish singer with Deacon Blue ("Real Gone Kid", "Dignity").
- 1983 — Natalie Cassidy (43), English actress (Sonia Fowler in EastEnders since 1993).
- 1986 — Robert Pattinson (40), English actor (Twilight saga, The Batman, Tenet, Mickey 17).

THE DAY TODAY

- 1940 — Winston Churchill delivers his first speech as Prime Minister, offering "nothing... but blood, toil, tears and sweat."
- 1981 — Pope John Paul II is shot and seriously wounded in St Peter's Square by Mehmet Ali Ağca. He survives and later visits his attacker in prison.
- 2004 — The series finale of "Frasier" airs in the US, drawing one of the largest sitcom finale audiences in NBC history.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1967 — The Monkees' second album "More of the Monkees" was at No.1 on the UK album chart. Only four albums went to No.1 in the UK during 1967.
- 1978 — Boney M were No.1 on the UK singles chart with "Rivers of Babylon".
- 1996 — Oasis became the fastest-selling band in UK history when all 330,000 tickets for their Knebworth and Loch Lomond shows sold out in nine hours. Tickets were £22.50.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1912 — The Royal Flying Corps, forerunner of the Royal Air Force, is established in the United Kingdom.
- 1917 — Three shepherd children at Fátima in Portugal report the first of their visions of the Virgin Mary.
- 1787 — The First Fleet of 11 ships carrying convicts bound for the new penal colony of Australia leaves Portsmouth.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 134 of the year, 231 days left in 2026. Tomorrow is International Astronomy Day, World Migratory Bird Day, National Dance Like a Chicken Day and National Underground America Day. Star sign Taurus, birthstone Emerald.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1944 — George Lucas (82), American filmmaker and creator of Star Wars and Indiana Jones.
- 1952 — David Byrne (74), Scottish-born American musician, lead singer of Talking Heads.
- 1969 — Cate Blanchett (57), Australian actress (Elizabeth, The Aviator, Carol, Tár).
- 1971 — Sofia Coppola (55), American filmmaker (Lost in Translation, The Virgin Suicides, Priscilla).
- 1984 — Mark Zuckerberg (42), American technology entrepreneur and co-founder of Facebook (Meta).
- 1984 — Olly Murs (42), English singer-songwriter and TV presenter ("Dance with Me Tonight", "Troublemaker").

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1796 — Edward Jenner performs the first documented smallpox vaccination, on eight-year-old James Phipps — the foundation of modern immunology.
- 1948 — David Ben-Gurion proclaims the establishment of the State of Israel as the British Mandate for Palestine expires.
- 1973 — Skylab, America's first space station, is launched into low Earth orbit by NASA.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1965 — The Rolling Stones recorded "(I Can't Get No) Satisfaction" at Chess Studios, Chicago.
- 1988 — Wet Wet Wet were No.1 in the UK with their version of "With a Little Help From My Friends", released for ChildLine.

Coming to cinemas

MAY 2026	
FRI 15	Mortal Kombat II (+ IMAX); Is God Is; Poetic License
FRI 22	The Mandalorian and Grogu (+ IMAX)
JUNE 2026	
FRI 5	Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad
FRI 12	Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life
JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

MAY 2026	
THU 14	PGA Championship begins (Golf)
WED 20	UEFA Europa League Final
SAT 23	EFL Championship Play-off Final, Wembley
SUN 24	Premier League final day (all 10 games, 3pm BST)
24 MAY – 7 JUN	French Open (Tennis)
THU 28	Premier League Darts Finals Night
SAT 30	UEFA Champions League Final

JUNE 2026	
THU 4	NBA Finals begin
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)
11–14 JUN	World Cup of Darts
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow

AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)